

Interior Window Cleaning SOP

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Scope: Interior reachable windows only — no ladders, no exterior, no second-story

Add-on price: +\$50 (all reachable windows in up to 3 bed home)

Time target: 30–45 min whole home | 5–8 min per window

Purpose

Clean windows brighten the entire home and are a high-visibility upsell. This SOP covers **interior glass you can reach safely from the floor or a standard step stool (max 2 steps)**.

Safety & Scope Limits

In scope:

- ☐ Interior glass panes reachable without ladder
- ☐ Window sills and tracks (interior)
- ☐ Sliding glass door interior (if reachable)

Out of scope — do not attempt:

- ☒ Exterior windows
 - ☒ Second-story or high transom windows
 - ☒ Window cleaning requiring ladder (refer to window specialist)
 - ☒ Removing window screens for exterior wash (unless trained and in deep/move-out scope)
 - ☒ Damaged or cracked glass — report, don't pressure
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Supplies

- ☐ Glass cleaner (ammonia-free preferred for tinted film)
- ☐ Microfiber cloths — 2 per window (wet/clean + dry/polish)
- ☐ Small scrub pad or old toothbrush (tracks)
- ☐ Vacuum crevice tool (tracks)

- ☐ Step stool (stable, 2-step max)
 - ☐ Plastic scraper (sticker residue on glass — test corner first)
 - ☐ Drop cloth or towel for sills
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Window Cleaning Order (Per Window)

Work one window at a time, top to bottom:

Step 1 — Sill & Track

- ☐ Vacuum track to remove dead bugs, dust, debris
- ☐ Scrub track with small brush and all-purpose cleaner
- ☐ Wipe sill dry — check for plant water stains

Step 2 — Frame & Ledge

- ☐ Dry dust frame top and sides
- ☐ Damp-wipe interior frame and ledge
- ☐ Wipe lock hardware and handle

Step 3 — Glass (The S Method)

- ☐ Remove loose dust with dry microfiber
- ☐ Spray glass cleaner on cloth (not heavily on glass — avoids drips on sills/walls)
- ☐ Wipe in **S-pattern** top to bottom, overlapping strokes
- ☐ Dry/polish with clean dry microfiber immediately
- ☐ Check from multiple angles for streaks

Step 4 — Final Check

- ☐ No drips on walls or sills
 - ☐ Lock and screen (if present) replaced properly
 - ☐ Open and close window to verify operation (don't force stuck windows)
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Glass Technique Details

Why spray the cloth, not the glass:

- Prevents damage to painted sills and wall below

- Reduces inhalation of spray in small bathrooms
- Gives better control on mirrors and small panes

Streak-free finish:

- ☐ Use two cloths minimum — one applies, one buffs
- ☐ Buff in circular motion on final pass
- ☐ Clean on cloudy day or indirect light when possible — sun dries cleaner too fast and streaks

Hard water spots (deep clean):

- ☐ Apply vinegar solution or calcium remover to cloth only
 - ☐ Spot treat, dwell 2 min, wipe and polish
 - ☐ Test tinted windows in corner first
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Mirrors (Same Technique)

Bathrooms and closet mirrors use identical S-method:

- ☐ Spray cloth, not mirror
 - ☐ Wipe top to bottom
 - ☐ Polish dry — check from doorway sightline (client's view)
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Sliding Glass Doors

- ☐ Vacuum and clean bottom track thoroughly (deepest dirt collects here)
 - ☐ Clean interior glass panel — both sides of interior-facing glass if reachable without going outside
 - ☐ Wipe door handle and lock
 - ☐ Time: 10–15 min per door
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Whole-Home Window Route

Efficient path for 3 bed home (~15–20 panes):

- ☐ Start upstairs (if applicable) — back rooms to stairs

- ☐ Main floor — bedrooms, living, dining, kitchen pass-throughs
- ☐ Bathrooms last (steam may re-fog if baths just cleaned — do windows before bath wet work OR return to buff)
- ☐ Kitchen window after stovetop work (grease mist lands on glass)

Pro tip: On deep cleans, do windows **after** dusting but **before** floor mop (sill debris falls to floor).

Quality Standards

Windows pass when:

- ☐ Glass is clear with no streaks, smudges, or fingerprints at normal viewing distance
 - ☐ Sills and tracks are debris-free
 - ☐ No cleaner residue on frames
 - ☐ Client can see through glass from main seating area
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Do NOT (Windows)

- ☒ Lean out of windows to reach exterior — ever
 - ☒ Use razor blades on tinted, coated, or Low-E glass
 - ☒ Use abrasive pads on glass
 - ☒ Clean windows in direct hot sun — streak city
 - ☒ Soak untreated wood sills
 - ☒ Remove screens you can't reinstall flush
 - ☒ Guarantee removal of construction paint overspray — refer to specialist
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Add-On Sales Script (For Your Team)

"Your regular clean covers the home surfaces. Interior windows are a \$50 add-on — all reachable panes, sills, and tracks. Most clients add it quarterly with the deep clean. Want me to include it today?"

100% Cleaner — Streak-free glass sells the upsell.